

Heuristic Evaluation Summary Report

Project	Assignment Submission System
Evaluators	He Chun · Rui Zhao · Zongru Li · Juyin
Method	Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics
Date	April 2026

Severity Rating Scale

Rating	Meaning
0	Not a usability problem
1	Cosmetic problem only
2	Minor usability problem
3	Major usability problem — high priority
4	Usability catastrophe — must fix before release

1. Introduction

This document consolidates the individual heuristic evaluation findings of four team members — **He Chun, Rui Zhao, Zongru Li, and Juyin** — into a single comprehensive report. Each evaluator independently assessed the Assignment Submission System against Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics.

The system supports two main roles: **Teachers** (create courses, enroll students, publish and grade assignments) and **Students** (log in, view courses, submit assignments, view grades). This report synthesizes recurring issues, identifies priority areas, and provides consolidated recommendations.

2. Individual Evaluator Summaries

He Chun

5-page detailed evaluation covering all 10 heuristics across both teacher and student workflows. Focus areas: enrollment workflow, submission requirements clarity, terminology consistency, and error messaging.

Rui Zhao

2-page code-level evaluation focused on the `Login`, `Home` (Dashboard), and `WorkspaceList` components. Identified a critical broken "Forgot Password" link (severity 4) and an accessibility mismatch in form labels.

Zongru Li

2-page tabular evaluation with screenshots. Key issues: missing password confirmation on the register form (severity 3) and vague error popups. Several heuristics passed with no issues identified.

Spreadsheet-based evaluation. Key issues: generic "Login failed" error message, missing password reset functionality, and no in-app help documentation for common workflows.

3. Consolidated Findings by Heuristic

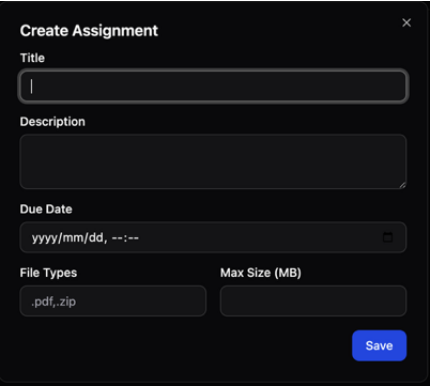
Max Sev. is the highest severity assigned by any evaluator for that heuristic.

#	Heuristic	Key Issues Found	Max Sev.	Evaluators
1	Visibility of System Status	- No loading state in WorkspaceList when switching modes (Rui Zhao) - Unclear loading state descriptions during data fetch (Zongru Li) - All actions provide clear feedback — <i>pass</i> (Juyin)	3	Rui Zhao, Zongru Li, Juyin
2	Match with Real World	"Workspace" vs "Course" terminology mismatch (He Chun, Rui Zhao) - Login error says "Login failed" with no explanation (Juyin, Rui Zhao)	2	All 4
3	User Control & Freedom	- No show/hide toggle on password field (Rui Zhao) - Enrollment requires teachers to enter internal User ID from memory (He Chun) - Back button supports history — <i>pass</i> (Zongru Li)	3	He Chun, Rui Zhao
4	Consistency & Standards	<code>htmlFor="email"</code> on label but <code>id="username"</code> on input — breaks accessibility (Rui Zhao) - Inconsistent status labels: Draft / Published / Submitted / Completed (He Chun) - Buttons and icons consistently placed — <i>pass</i> (Juyin, Zongru Li)	3	He Chun, Rui Zhao
5	Error Prevention	- No "Confirm Password" field on register form (Zongru Li) - No client-side input validation before network requests (Rui Zhao) - Confirmation dialogs before destructive actions — <i>pass</i> (Juyin)	3	Rui Zhao, Zongru Li
6	Recognition Rather Than Recall	- No back/cancel button on Login and Signup screens (Rui Zhao) - Archive/delete confirmation dialogs missing consequence explanation (He Chun) - All options presented as dropdowns — <i>pass</i> (Juyin)	2	He Chun, Rui Zhao
7	Flexibility & Efficiency of Use	- No keyboard shortcuts for end-user actions (He Chun, Zongru Li, Juyin) - Teacher Dashboard requires extra navigation steps to reach course actions (Rui Zhao)	2	All 4
8	Aesthetic & Minimalist Design	- Leftover <code>console.log("test", course)</code> in production UI code (Rui Zhao) - Generic error messages: "Failed to save", "Submission failed" (He Chun) - Clean, uncluttered interface — <i>pass</i> (Juyin)	3	He Chun, Rui Zhao
9	Help Users Recover from Errors	- Error popups only notify an error occurred — no detail (Zongru Li) - Generic "Login Failed" toast with no specific cause (Rui Zhao, Juyin) "Forgot password?" present but no reset is implemented (Juyin, Rui Zhao)	3	Rui Zhao, Zongru Li, Juyin

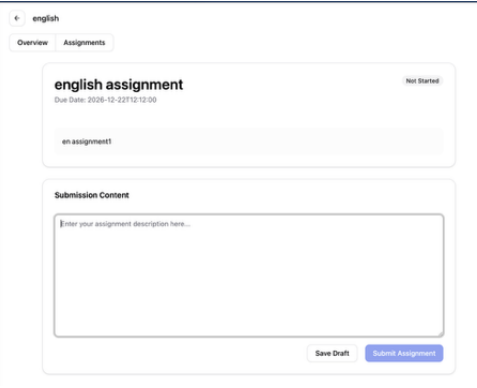
10	Help & Documentation	"Forgot Password" redirects to a YouTube video instead of a reset page (Rui Zhao, severity 4) - No in-app help, tooltips, or documentation for key workflows (He Chun, Juyin) - Help explanations present where needed — <i>pass</i> (Zongru Li)	4	He Chun, Rui Zhao, Juyin
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4. Screenshots from Original Reports

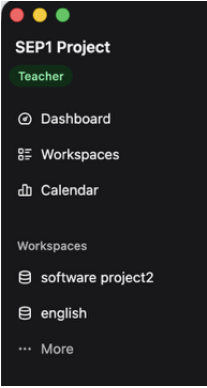
He Chun



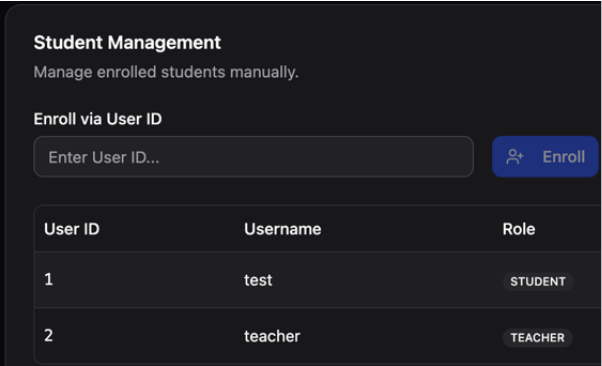
H1-1: Assignment submission page



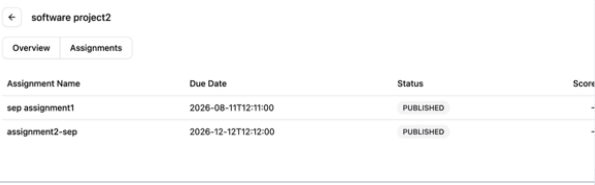
H1-2: Workspace/Course terminology



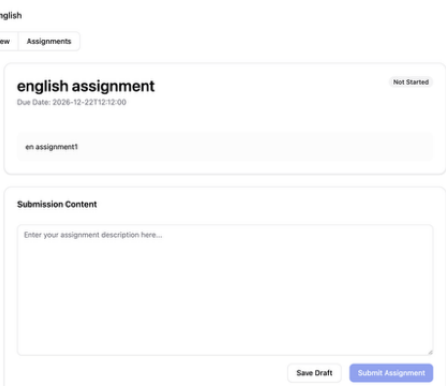
H1-3: Enrollment by User ID



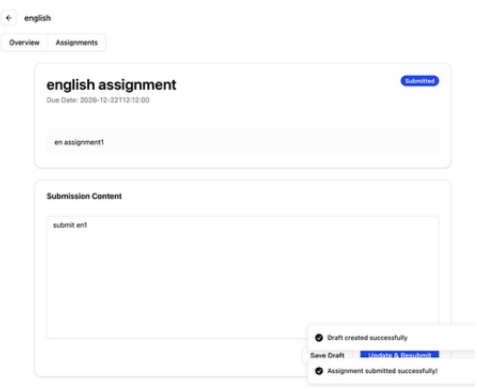
H1-4: Status label inconsistency



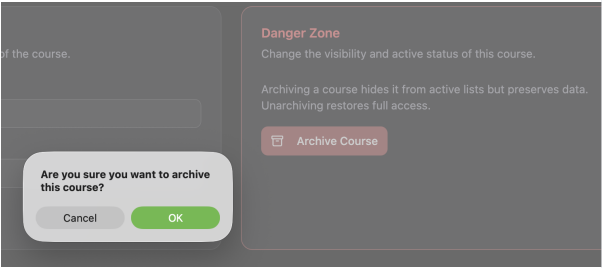
H1-4: Consistency (cont.)



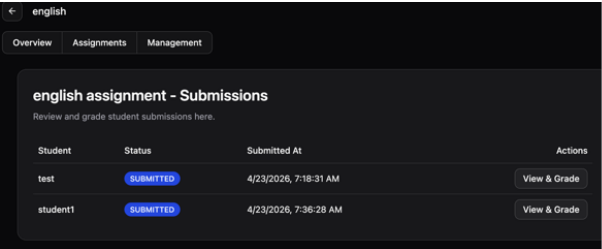
H1-5: Toast notifications



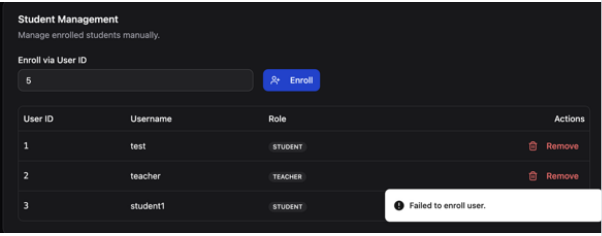
H1-5: Published/submitted state



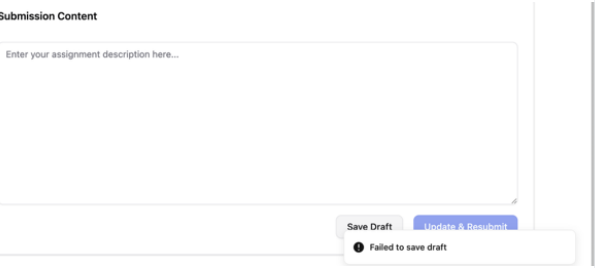
H1-6: Confirmation dialog



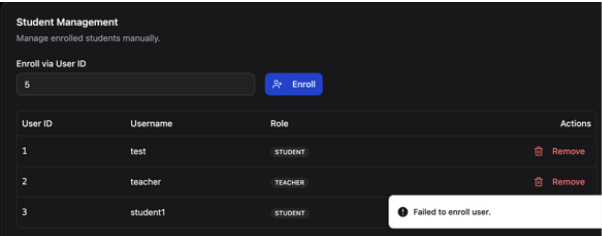
H1-6: Danger Zone section



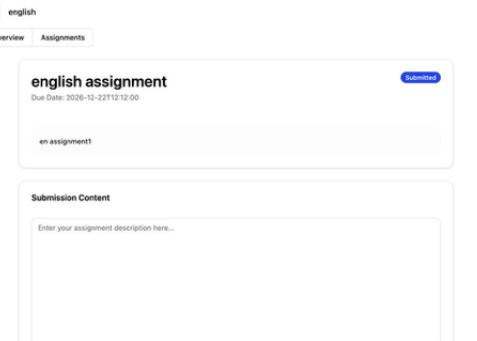
H1-7: Grading workflow

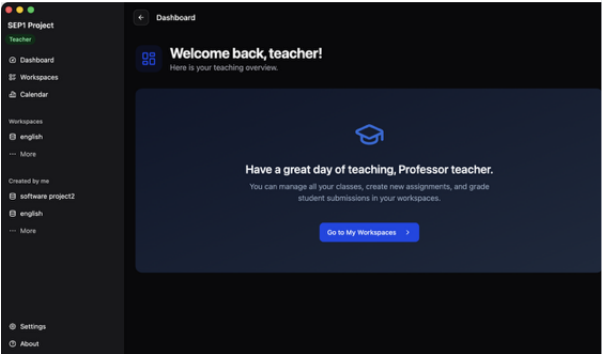


H1-8: Generic error messages



H1-9: Enrollment validation





Save DraftUpdate & Resubmit

H1-9: Submission requirements

teacher

H1-10: Help & Documentation

Zongru Li

Password

Must be at least 8 characters long.

Create Account

H1-2: Loading state clarity

←

Data structure and algrithms

H1-5: Missing password confirmation

Login failed

H1-9: Vague error popup

Danger Zone

Change the visibility and active status of this course.

Archiving a course hides it from active lists but preserves data. Unarchiving restores full access.

Archive Course

H1-10: Help text present

5. Priority Improvements

#	Issue	Sev.	Evaluators	Recommended Fix
1	"Forgot Password" link redirects to YouTube	4	Rui Zhao	Implement a real password reset flow with email link
2	Missing "Confirm Password" field on register form	3	Zongru Li	Add second password input with matching validation
3	Generic error messages with no actionable detail	3	All 4	Display specific backend error messages to the user
4	No loading state in WorkspaceList when switching modes	3	Rui Zhao	Add spinner driven by <code>coursesCreatedLoading</code> state
5	<code>htmlFor</code> / <code>id</code> mismatch breaks screen readers	3	Rui Zhao	Fix <code>FieldLabel</code> to use <code>htmlFor="username"</code>
6	Student enrollment requires memorising internal User ID	3	He Chun	Add student search by name/email with selectable list
7	Error popups show no detail beyond "an error occurred"	3	Zongru Li, Juyin	Parse backend error codes to display meaningful messages
8	Terminology inconsistency: "Workspace" vs "Course"	2	He Chun, Rui Zhao	Standardize to "Course" across all components and routes
9	No keyboard shortcuts for power users	2	All 4	Add shortcuts for grading and a "Recent Courses" section
10	No in-app help or documentation	1	He Chun, Juyin	Add tooltips and a help page for key workflows

6. Conclusion

The Assignment Submission System provides the core functionality required for academic course and assignment management. However, the heuristic evaluation conducted by four independent evaluators reveals a consistent set of usability problems that should be addressed before final release.

The most critical issue — identified by Rui Zhao with **severity 4** — is the "Forgot Password" link routing users to YouTube rather than a password reset page. Three evaluators independently flagged missing error detail in login and error popups (severity 3), while He Chun and Zongru Li both highlighted that the student enrollment workflow and register form lack essential validation.

The most frequently cited improvement areas across all 10 heuristics are: **error prevention and recovery** (H1-5, H1-9), **precise error messaging** (H1-8), **terminology consistency** (H1-2, H1-4), and **help & documentation** (H1-10). Addressing the top 5 priority items in Section 5 would substantially improve the usability, accessibility, and reliability of the system for both teachers and students.